

Fire battle shifts to new front

Change in wind prompts evacuations in Brentwood, Encino and Tarzana



AN AERIAL view of the Palisades fire as it burns near MountainGate Country Club, bottom right, on Saturday. A wind shift late Friday sent the fire north and east. MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

CAN THE SOUL OF ALTADENA SURVIVE?

BY COLLEEN SHALBY, MELISSA GOMEZ AND BRITTNY MEJIA

For some, Altadena's draw has been the seclusion it offers, nestled in the foothills of the San Gabriel Mountains, straddling the line between urban and wild. For others, it's been the community where Black residents sought refuge decades ago amid the legacy of defunct racial redlining. And then there has always been Altadena's sense of freedom and creativity that gave rise to an artists' enclave and The Bunny Museum. Whatever drew them,

this unincorporated town north of Pasadena represented an alluring, magical combination of solitude and community for more than 42,000 residents, many whose families had lived there for generations in an eclectic mix of homes — from streets lined with small bungalow homes and neighborhoods of sprawling Spanish style and Colonial mansions amid graceful oaks. Here, affordable home prices made ownership a reality. Neighbors checked in if they noticed a light on late. Full-moon parties were anticipated celebrations. Doz- [See Altadena, A7]



GUTTED businesses and vehicles line Lake Avenue in Altadena, where a cherished way of life in the eclectic foothill community was upended by the Eaton fire. CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

Weather allows surge in airdrops

BY GRACE TOOHEY, CLARA HARTER, RONG-GONG LIN II, DAKOTA SMITH AND JAMES QUEALLY

An epic aerial assault was underway Saturday as a fleet of aircraft worked to prevent the Palisades fire from hitting homes in Brentwood and Encino. A shift in winds late Friday sent the fire north and east through the Santa Monica Mountains, forcing evacuations of Brentwood and the hills of Encino and Tarzana — keeping Los Angeles on edge in Day 5 of an unprecedented fire siege that has already damaged or destroyed more than 10,000 structures and killed at least 13 people. All morning, firefighting helicopters and airplanes dropped water and fire retardant on fire lines not far from the 405 Freeway in an attempt to prevent flames from engulfing more neigh- [See Wildfires, A8]

Why water ran out as crisis raged

BY IAN JAMES, MATT HAMILTON, AND RUBEN VIVES

As crews have fought the fast-spreading fires across the Los Angeles area, they have repeatedly been hampered by low water pressure and fire hydrants that have gone dry. These problems have exposed what experts say are vulnerabilities in city water supply systems not built for wildfires on this scale. The water system that supplies neighborhoods simply doesn't have the capacity to deliver such large volumes of water over several hours, said Martin Adams, former general manager of the Los Angeles Department of Water and Power. "The system has never been designed to fight a wildfire that then envelops a community," Adams said in an interview with The Times. The limitations of local water systems complicated firefighting efforts in Pacific Palisades, where scores of [See Water, A10]



BRIAN VAN DER BRUG Los Angeles Times

TIMES REPORTER James Rainey looks over the Carbon Canyon neighborhood where he grew up.

COLUMN ONE

In ashes, traces of 'old' Malibu and my youth

BY JAMES RAINEY

As I drove up Pacific Coast Highway, the postcard places of my childhood rushed by. The Malibu Feed Bin — the country store where our family sold wildflower honey made from the dozens of beehives we tended in our backyard. The Reel Inn — where we sat at picnic tables and gobbled down cut-rate seafood, and where my dad once asked a guy in line about an acting job. Something's Fishy — the sushi place of yesteryear where my brother worked as a busboy and where sake warmed the soul after a day in the cold Pacific. All gone now, reduced to ash, like so many other landmarks of my youth. So I kept driving up PCH, my eyes overwhelmed with the grim new images, while my [See Malibu, A12]

Frenzied house hunters driven by desperation

BY JACK FLEMMING, ANDREW KHOURI, DANIEL MILLER AND LIAM DILLON

Thousands of families were displaced on Tuesday when fires torched homes throughout Pacific Palisades and Altadena, kicking off a regionwide house hunt as victims scoured a tight market looking for homes to rent — or even buy. People are desperate, local agents said. Their homes are in ashes, and they're looking for stability — somewhere for their family to go that's not a shelter, a friend's house or a hotel room. Some landlords are now sharply

raising rent, even beyond what temporary price gouging protections allow. And some would-be renters are offering a year's rent upfront in cash and engaging in bidding wars. "Dozens and dozens of people are going after the same properties," said David Berg, a Compass real estate agent with Smith & Berg Property Group. "Since Tuesday afternoon, our phones have rung hundreds of times." On Friday, Berg and F. Ron Smith listed a newly built home in Brentwood, just a short hop from the Palisades. An hour after hitting the market, the listing [See Housing, A6]

Paradise lost on PCH

The fire came out of the wild and into the city, all the way down to the beach. There's still shock. A9

How to talk with loved ones about loss

There is no perfect thing to say. Just reach out. Plus, more tips to help your family and friends. A12

LAFD chief meets with the mayor

Kristin Crowley said city had failed department. Now they're in "lockstep," Karen Bass says. CALIFORNIA, B1

Birthplace of Doors' No. 1 hit burns

Guitarist Robby Krieger began writing "Light My Fire" in his parents' Palisades home. CALIFORNIA, B3

Trump firm loosens curbs

Unlike during his first term, his company will allow deals with private entities abroad. NATION, A4

Chargers' season comes to sad end

Texans win wild-card game 32-12 as Justin Herbert is intercepted four times. SPORTS, D1

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 68/41. B7

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